

Inductive vs. Deductive Reasoning in Nursing – 40 Practice Questions

1. 1. Patients with high sodium intake often show signs of hypertension. Therefore, high sodium intake probably contributes to hypertension.

Answer: Inductive

2. 2. All patients with sepsis exhibit a high heart rate. This patient has sepsis. Therefore, they should have a high heart rate.

Answer: Deductive

3. 3. Several patients improved after receiving early ambulation post-surgery. Therefore, early ambulation likely promotes faster recovery.

Answer: Inductive

4. 4. All patients allergic to penicillin should avoid amoxicillin. This patient is allergic to penicillin. Therefore, they must avoid amoxicillin.

Answer: Deductive

5. 5. Nurses observed that most patients on a specific medication developed rashes. So, they suspect the drug causes skin reactions.

Answer: Inductive

6. 6. If a patient is dehydrated, their blood pressure will drop. This patient is dehydrated. Therefore, their BP is expected to be low.

Answer: Deductive

7. 7. Patients on long-term bed rest frequently develop pressure ulcers. Therefore, bed rest likely contributes to ulcer development.

Answer: Inductive

8. 8. All insulin-dependent diabetics need regular blood glucose monitoring. This patient is insulin-dependent. Therefore, they need frequent checks.

Answer: Deductive

9. 9. Most elderly patients on sedatives are more prone to falls. Therefore, sedatives might increase fall risk.

Answer: Inductive

10. 10. Every time the bed was not lowered, patients were more likely to fall. So, keeping beds high probably contributes to falls.

Answer: Inductive

11. 11. All patients with asthma should carry a rescue inhaler. John has asthma. Therefore, he should carry a rescue inhaler.

Answer: Deductive

12. 12. Patients with good sleep habits tend to heal faster after surgery. Therefore, better sleep might support healing.

Answer: Inductive

13. 13. If a wound is infected, it will show redness and swelling. This wound is red and swollen. So, it's likely infected.
Answer: Deductive
14. 14. Many patients with high stress report gastrointestinal symptoms. Therefore, stress may contribute to GI issues.
Answer: Inductive
15. 15. All patients with urinary tract infections (UTIs) report dysuria. This patient has a UTI. Therefore, they should have dysuria.
Answer: Deductive
16. 16. You've noticed that patients who participate in health education are more compliant with treatment. So education probably improves compliance.
Answer: Inductive
17. 17. If potassium is too low, patients may have muscle weakness. This patient has low potassium. So they may be weak.
Answer: Deductive
18. 18. Many patients given extra fluids experienced improved blood pressure. So IV fluids likely help stabilize BP.
Answer: Inductive
19. 19. All patients with liver failure have high bilirubin levels. This patient has liver failure. So they likely have high bilirubin.
Answer: Deductive
20. 20. Patients who walk daily in rehab recover function more quickly. Therefore, daily ambulation likely enhances recovery.
Answer: Inductive
21. 21. If a medication causes drowsiness, patients should not drive after taking it. This drug causes drowsiness. So the patient shouldn't drive.
Answer: Deductive
22. 22. Nurses noticed more infections in patients with unwashed hands before meals. So hand hygiene likely reduces infections.
Answer: Inductive
23. 23. All patients with anaphylaxis need epinephrine. This patient has anaphylaxis. Therefore, they need epinephrine.
Answer: Deductive
24. 24. After observing better outcomes in patients repositioned every 2 hours, a nurse concludes that frequent turning helps prevent pressure ulcers.
Answer: Inductive
25. 25. A nurse knows that all patients post-op need monitoring for vital sign changes. Therefore, they check vitals on a post-op patient.
Answer: Deductive

26. 26. A nurse observes that several patients on a high-fiber diet have regular bowel movements. So, fiber may promote GI health.
Answer: Inductive
27. 27. Every patient given a flu vaccine showed mild side effects. This patient was vaccinated. So, they will likely show side effects.
Answer: Deductive
28. 28. Patients who received counseling before discharge had lower readmission rates. So discharge counseling may prevent rehospitalization.
Answer: Inductive
29. 29. If oxygen saturation is below 90%, the patient is hypoxic. This patient has 88% SpO2. Therefore, they are hypoxic.
Answer: Deductive
30. 30. Most patients with depression report sleep disturbances. So, sleep issues may be a sign of depression.
Answer: Inductive
31. 31. If a patient has pneumonia, they may have crackles on auscultation. This patient has pneumonia. So crackles are expected.
Answer: Deductive
32. 32. A nurse notices that most patients who use incentive spirometry have fewer post-op lung infections. So, it's likely beneficial.
Answer: Inductive
33. 33. All patients in isolation need PPE. This patient is in isolation. Therefore, use PPE.
Answer: Deductive
34. 34. Several patients improved after deep breathing exercises. Therefore, these exercises likely help in recovery.
Answer: Inductive
35. 35. If the blood sugar is below 70, the patient is hypoglycemic. This patient has a reading of 65. So they are hypoglycemic.
Answer: Deductive
36. 36. Patients who get regular health checkups often detect diseases earlier. Therefore, regular checkups might aid early diagnosis.
Answer: Inductive
37. 37. All patients with appendicitis report lower right quadrant pain. This patient has that pain. Therefore, they may have appendicitis.
Answer: Deductive
38. 38. Most patients who avoid allergens have fewer asthma attacks. Therefore, allergen avoidance probably helps.
Answer: Inductive

39. 39. If a wound is infected, it will produce pus. This wound has pus. Therefore, it is likely infected.

Answer: Deductive

40. 40. Patients with balanced diets recover faster. So good nutrition probably supports healing.

Answer: Inductive

mcq_questions = [

("Which of the following is an example of inductive reasoning in nursing?", [

- A. All patients with asthma need inhalers. This patient has asthma. So they need an inhaler.",
- B. The nurse noticed that patients who walk more tend to recover faster. So walking might help healing.",
- C. If potassium is low, the patient has muscle weakness. This patient has low potassium. So they will be weak.",
- D. All patients in isolation require gloves. This patient is in isolation. So gloves are needed."

Answer "B"

41. ("Deductive reasoning moves from:", [

- A. Specific observations to general conclusions",
- B. Guessing to testing",
- C. "C. General principles to specific conclusions",
- D. "D. Observations to hypotheses"

Answer , "C",

42. ("A nurse concludes that deep breathing exercises reduce pneumonia after observing many cases. This is an example of:", [

- 43. "A. Deductive reasoning",
- 44. "B. Inductive reasoning",
- 45. "C. Trial and error",
- 46. "D. Diagnostic reasoning"

Answer "B",

47. ("If a patient has low hemoglobin, they are anemic. This patient has low hemoglobin. So they are anemic.' This is an example of:", [

- A. Inductive reasoning",
- B. Clinical guessing",
- C. Deductive reasoning",
- D. Probabilistic thinking"

Answer "C"

48. ("Which type of reasoning is most associated with forming a hypothesis from patterns?",

- A. "A. Deductive",
- B. "B. Inductive",
- C. "C. Descriptive",
- D. "D. Abstract"

Answer "B"

49. True/False

- 1. ("Deductive reasoning always guarantees the truth of the conclusion if the premises are true.", "True"),
- 2. ("Inductive reasoning provides absolute proof of a conclusion.", "False"),
- 3. ("A nurse using trends in patient behavior to predict outcomes is using inductive reasoning.", "True"),
- 4. ("If a patient is hypoglycemic, they will always faint. This is an example of inductive reasoning.", "False"),
- 5. ("All patients in ICU require cardiac monitoring. This patient is in ICU. So they require monitoring. This is deductive reasoning.", "True"),